Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY
Philippine Atmospheric, Geophysical and Astronomical Services Administration (PAGASA)
Climatology and Agrometeorology Division (CAD)
Climate Monitoring and Prediction Section (CLIMPS)

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BAGONG PILIPINAS

ENSO ADVISORY

El Niño Advisory No. 5

A strong to very strong El Niño is present in the Tropical Pacific. Forecasts predict that El Niño will continue until the first half of 2027 and may reach its peak before the end of 2026.

El Niño increases the likelihood of below-normal rainfall, which may lead to adverse impacts, including dry spells and droughts in some areas of the country. However, above-normal rainfall conditions may still occur during the passage of tropical cyclones and other rain-bearing weather systems.

Assessment for September 2026

The weather systems that influenced the weather and climate of the country during the month were the Southwest (SW) Monsoon, easterlies, localized thunderstorms, low-pressure areas (LPAs), intertropical convergence zone (ITCZ), and the passage of two (2) tropical cyclones (TCs) in the Philippine Area of Responsibility (PAR): Tropical Storm (TS) “Pilandok” (KROVANH) from August 30 to September 03, and Typhoon (TY) “Queenie” (SURIGAE) from September 24-27.

The rainfall assessment for the month showed that most areas of the country experienced below- to near-normal rainfall conditions. However, patches of above-normal rainfall were observed in Benguet, La Union, Pangasinan, Bataan, Zambales, and Cavite. Way below-normal rainfall conditions were also observed in the Negros Provinces.

In addition, seven (7) provinces experienced meteorological drought; three (3) provinces were under dry spell; and thirty (30) provinces experienced dry conditions. For a complete list of these provinces, please refer to the meteorological **Drought/Dry Spell Assessment** Maps and Tables or the **PH Meteorological Drought Monitor**, both available on the official DOST-PAGASA website.

Slightly above- to above-average mean surface air temperatures were observed over most of the country during the month, except for select areas in Luzon, including Baguio, Camarines Sur, and Northern Palawan, where cooler-than-average temperatures were recorded. The observed temperature ranges were as follows: mountainous areas of Luzon (13.4°C – 25.2°C); Metro Manila (23.8°C – 35.1°C); rest of Luzon (19.8°C – 36.8°C); Visayas (22.5°C – 37.7°C); mountainous areas of Mindanao (17.5°C – 33.5C); rest of Mindanao (20.9°C – 37.0°C). Meanwhile, four (4) stations have surpassed their highest maximum temperature record for September: Catbalogan, Samar on September 2 (37.2°C); Borongan, Eastern Samar on September 3 (37.7°C); Laguindingan Airport, Misamis Oriental on September 4 (37.0°C), and Zamboanga City on September 11 (36.2°C).

Outlook for October 2026

The weather systems expected to affect the country in October are the ITCZ, LPAs, localized thunderstorms, easterlies, ridge of the high-pressure area (HPA), and the occurrence of one (1) to two (2) TCs that may develop within or enter the PAR. Meanwhile, a transition to the Northeast (NE) Monsoon is likely this month.

The rainfall forecast for October suggests that below-normal rainfall conditions will be experienced over most parts of Luzon, Visayas, and Caraga Region, while near-normal rainfall conditions are likely over Batanes, Cagayan, Negros Island Region, Central Visayas, and the rest of Mindanao.

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Based on observed rainfall during the past months and the forecast for October, meteorological drought/dry spells are likely to be experienced by the end of the month in most parts of Bicol Region, Eastern Visayas, Surigao del Norte and Dinagat Islands. Meanwhile, dry conditions are likely over Abra, Kalinga, Isabela, Quezon, and most of MIMAROPA and Western Visayas.

Meanwhile, near-average to warmer-than-average mean air temperatures are expected over most parts of the country, while slightly cooler-than-average temperatures over some parts of MIMAROPA and Bohol. The ranges of forecast temperature are as follows: 13.1°C – 26.7°C in the mountainous areas of Luzon, 21.1°C – 36.0°C for Metro Manila, 17.0°C – 37.2°C over the rest of Luzon, 21.2°C – 36.5°C in Visayas, 15.9°C – 33.7°C in the mountainous areas of Mindanao, and 20.6°C – 37.7°C over the rest of Mindanao.

DOST-PAGASA will continue to closely monitor the ongoing El Niño and its associated impacts on the country's climate. Meanwhile, all government agencies and the general public are strongly advised to take appropriate preparedness and response measures to mitigate the impacts of El Niño, particularly in areas vulnerable to dry spells and warmer temperatures.

For more information, please call the Climatology and Agrometeorology Division (CAD) at (02)8284-0800, local 4920 or 4921.

Originally Signed

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Administrator

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